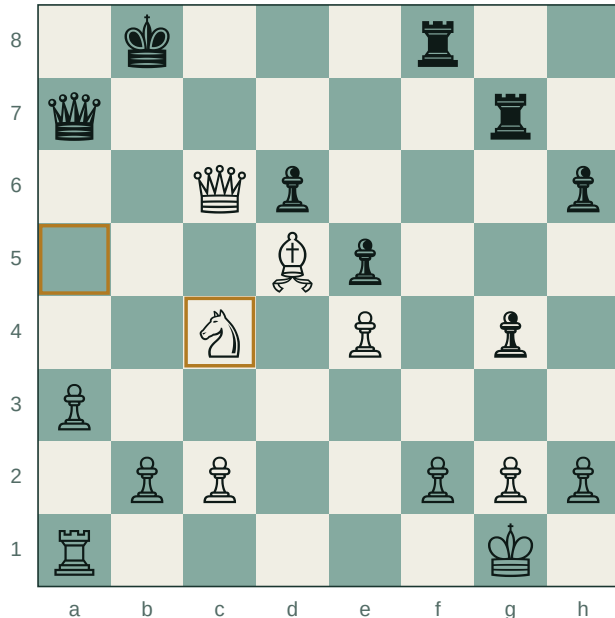


# Mate in three: Black, move 35

Mate in three

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Nc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**35...Qxf2+ 36. Kh1 Qf1+ 37. Rxf1 Rxf1#**

**35...Qxf2+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on f2. Recorded reply: **36.Kh1**.

**36...Qf1+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f1 it attacks king on h1, rook on a1 and knight on c4. Recorded reply: **37.Rxf1**.

**37...Rxf1#** Mate: rook on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.